

Mobile rail tickets?

Indian Railways has announced a new SMS-based system for purchasing rail tickets on mobile phones, a system that will reportedly roll out soon

And in other news...

A lot has happened all over Google's web properties apart from just Google+. The search giant has made many feature and UI changes, applying what's being called a unified design philosophy, inspired by Google+'s clean layout, dark interface and icons. Here we give you a lowdown on some of these changes. First up is YouTube Cosmic Panda, a new experimental user interface that brings new features and layouts to videos, playlists and channels, as well as new editing tools and channel page designs. YouTube is awaiting feedback before fully incorporating the new ideas. The Blogger platform was also completely redesigned, incorporating several features such as the improved text editor and mobile blog support. Google Analytics tools have been added to the dashboard.

Over at Gmail, Google added the inbox style option, allowing users to quickly switch between style presets in a tab-like format, or a dropdown menu. There are five different style presets, to be used depending on personal taste, usage scenarios, etc. Google Docs has got better document sorting and sharing on the go with

the improved Google Docs for mobile. Also new are Google Docs' videos features, which allow users to insert, embed or caption videos from their Google Docs lists to their Google Sites. Both, Gmail and Google Docs can now also preview ZIP/RAR archives directly as attachments.

The shared photos are viewable under a photo topic by other Photovine users who can add to them, thus creating an image thread.

Google Translate also supports five new Indic languages – Bengali, Gujarati, Kannada, Tamil and Telugu – bringing the count up to 63. In related news, Google has tied up with the British Library and will soon be releasing thousands of historic books online for free.

World of browsers

Firefox 5 has been released as the first offering from the new rapid release model that Mozilla has adopted for most of its products. The biggest new change in Firefox 5 is with the add-on compatibility process, featuring an add-on compatibility scanner and version changer. A manual validation process is available as

well. Mozilla has also developed a new add-on SDK for Firefox, which allows developers to create add-ons using web standard technologies. Firefox 5 also brings a number of small new features, bug-fixes and improvements.

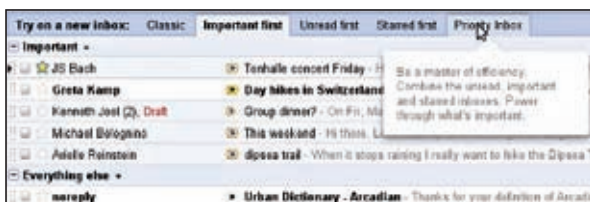


Opera's slightly new look

Opera 11.5 comes with Speed Dial extensions, with which developers can create widgets that will display in place of one of the speed dial entries. Additionally, the browser has a new menu and tab interface, the usual bug fixes, performance improvements and tweaks to the graphics engine.

Microsoft Office 365 launched in India

Microsoft has extended its major stride in the cloud computing segment, Office 365, to India. Microsoft says the Office 365 will provide affordable businesses productivity tools on the cloud. The suite, comprising Word, Excel, PowerPoint, email and other software, can be used by enterprises on a pay-per-use basis. The Office 365 plans start at \$2 (₹88) per month for basic e-mail and going up to \$27 (₹1,197) per month. ■



Gmail's new inbox styles



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